

and then press it all the way down. Most shutter-lag snags will disappear with just this little bit of care.

2.4 Shutter Priority Mode

Much to the relief of the photography-illiterate, almost all digital cameras set their shutter speeds automatically. The camera senses the level of light in the environment and even controls the lens aperture. But this is in *program mode* or when your camera is on auto-pilot. If you know exactly what settings you want, you can override the camera's settings and fix the shutter at the stop you need manually using the *Shutter Priority Mode*.

The Shutter Priority Mode (or Shutter Mode) is the reverse of Aperture Priority Mode (or Aperture Mode). Shutter priority mode is also called *Time Value Mode* on some cameras and you could find it on the dial represented by the letters 'Tv' or just 'S'. For those cameras without a dial, you'll need to press 'Menu' to access the available modes. This basically allows you to choose the shutter speed yourself. Accordingly, the camera sets the aperture value to the corresponding f-number.

Shutter mode is the best choice for action photos and for particular photographic effects. Fast exposures are excellent for stop action and slow exposures serve to blur moving subjects. Particularly exciting is *burst mode* – when the



Dial 'S' for shutter speed

camera takes a series of photos in rapid succession, letting you choose the one that caught the crucial moment later.

You could alternate shutter speed and aperture by using 'stops'. A fast shutter speed would need a larger aperture (and so, a smaller f-number). On the other hand, a slow shutter speed would need a smaller aperture. Raising the aperture value while simultaneously lowering the shutter stop value would give you the same exposure because a stop up and